Sovereign team advances in state tourney

After opening the tournament with a tough loss, the Sovereign Elevator men's fast pitch team has assured itself a tie for fifth place in the state men's fast pitch tournament held in Des Moines this past weekend by winning the next three ball games of the double elimination 'open' state tournament.

The tournament is not over, however, as rain delays had the tournament continued into this coming weekend with the Sovereign team scheduled to take on Sioux City at 9:00 a.m. Saturday morning in Des Moines. If the Sovereign team would win that game, they would be assured of a fourth place finish in the tournament.

"We're playing a pretty good tournament so far," stated Merle Sovereign, who is the player-coach for the team. "We had a real fine tournament defensively and have come up with enough runs against tough pitching to pick up some important wins," he added.

The coach pointed out that both pitchers, Jim Sovereign and Joe Wedeking, threw well during the weekend and that the combination was responsible for giving up only 11 hits in the 29 innings pitched. Between the two pitchers, there were a total of 28 strike outs.

Going back to the defensive play of the team, Merle noted that just about all the plays went smoothly for the team and that had things not gone well the team could have been eliminated earlier in the tournament. "When you're down there facing the best the state has to offer, all it takes is one mistake and you're beat. When we had the pressure on us it seemed like we came up with the clutch play," Sovereign generalized. The coach pointed to the game with Ankeny that was won in the eighth inning after battling to a 1-1 score after seven innings. He pointed out that in the fifth inning a bunted ball with a runner on third had Lindsay Lienhard making the play to first after holding the runner at third with the play then going to home where Merle Sovereign was able to make the tag on the runner from third when he attempted to score after the play went to first. The double play stopped a scoring threat that could have resulted in the game ending in seven innings with the Sovereign team down 2-1. "Then in the eighth we came up with four runs and that ended it," Merle added.

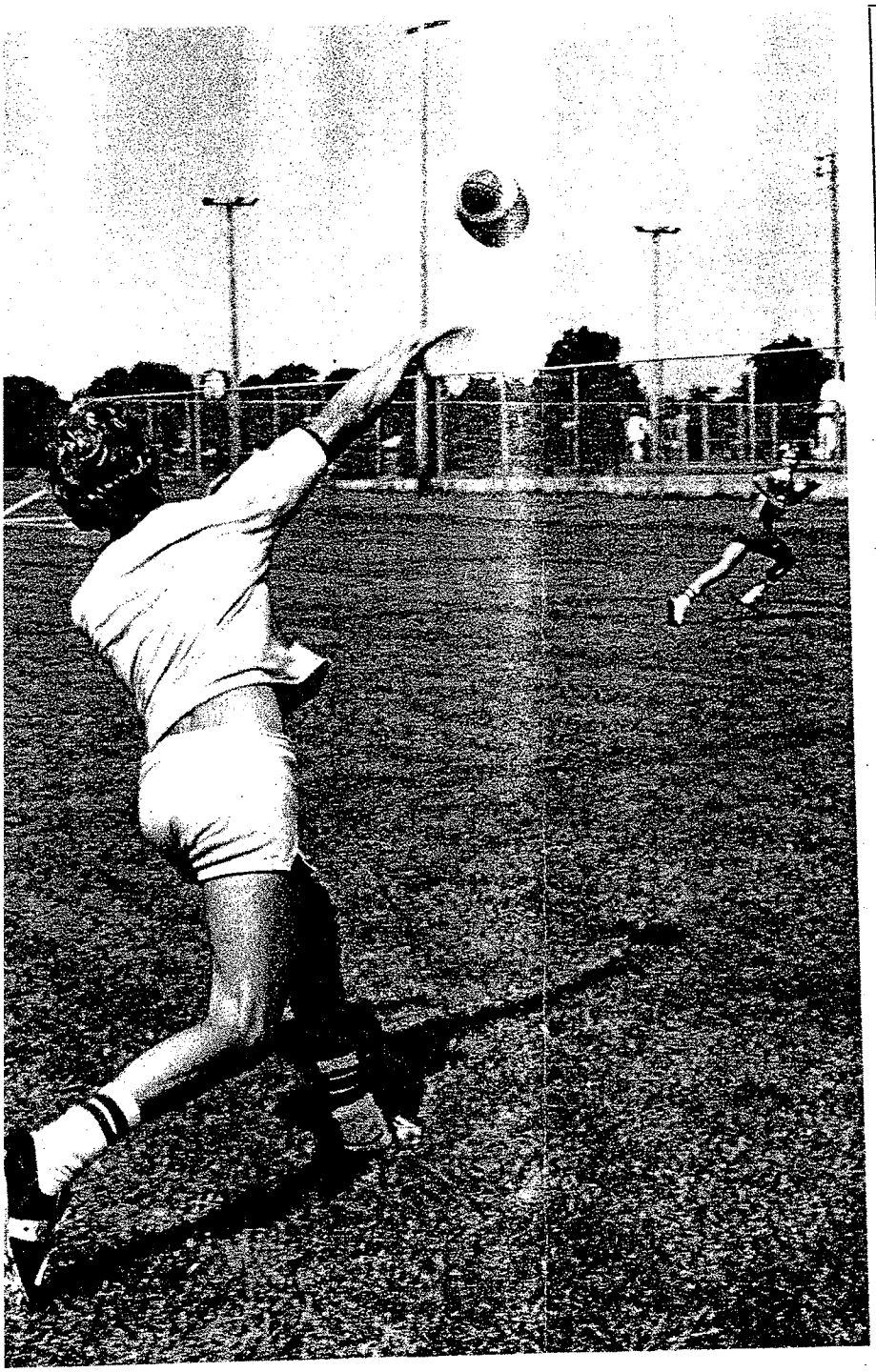
Pointing out the low scoring totals for all the games, Merle was quick to note that against these type of teams two runs given up can easily mean a game. "A look at the first game had Jim (Sovereign) throwing a one hitter and losing the game when we had things going against us for one inning... that's just how close all the games are," Merle stated. He also recalled that Butt'r Topp of Clear Lake won a 1-0 decision over Modern Piping of Cedar Rapids despite the Cedar Rapids pitcher throwing a no-hitter against Butt'r Topp.

"Right now we're just taking the games one at a time. We think we've got a good shot at beating Sioux City in the opener Saturday but only time will tell," he ended.

In the tournament opener for the Sovereign team Thursday evening, the local team was downed by the Sully team that placed third in the state meet last year. The Sovereign team had only two hits for the night with none of the three base runners ever getting past first base in the game.

On the other hand, the Sully team only had one hit for the game but that came after a walk and an error put two runners in scoring position. With the timely hit, the Sovereign team was beaten 2-0.

On Saturday afternoon, the Sovereign team took on Moulton Painting of Des Moines and took a 2-0 decision from the team to win the opener of the loser



SHARPENS THE ARM—Eric Taylor, a junior quarterback for the Crestwood football team, lets loose with a pass to a teammate during the opening football practice Monday morning. While most of the practice consisted of conditioning tests, the offensive unit for Cadet squad was able to run through some of the passing drills later in the morning.

racket in the double elimination tourna-
ıent. The Sovereign team scored one run
ı the third inning of the game when
ıindsay Lienhard had a single and stole
second. Merle Sovereign followed by reaching base on an error with the throw to first on the bunt going into the outfield and Lienhard scoring on the play. The second run of the game came in the seventh inning when Merle Sovereign was walked with that being followed with a single from Mark Serfling. Dave Testroet drove in the second run with a sacrifice handled by the pitcher.

In the game against Moulton Painting, [illegible] went the distance as he did

Sports Jargon

By Jim T

Perhaps it's a bit premature but I'm already excited about the Crestwood football season after having watched the opening c practice yesterday morning. I don't know what it was for certain bu the players themselves were ready for the season and were already look forward to the day the pads go on for hard contact.

While very little football was actually played Monday, the things impressed me... that is to say the preconditioning test of the athlete people coming in to practice in pretty good shape.

After a short talk to open things up, the athletes went to the weigh were tested for their ability to bench press the most weight they c quite a scene to see 37 young athletes pulling for each other as each put out his best. What came out of the test was that on the average players could bench press just under 220 pounds. It was also easily athletes spent time in the weight machine room during the summe

From there, the athletes went outside and were timed on 40 yard despite running on a wet track that slowed times down a bit, I was impressed. While I didn't sit down and figure this average out, I wou that the average time for the players was between 5.2 and 5 Crestwood does have good speed this year.

Along with the forward run, the athletes were also tested for the run backwards in order to find out who might be best for the secondary. Once again there were a good number of gifted athletes there.

Perhaps the least impressive part of the testing was the 12 minut anyone who wasn't a lineman was expected to run at least seven quarter mile track while linemen were expected to get in at least six 12 minute timing. All but a few backs did better than the seven lap and only four linemen weren't able to get the six laps in. The ath show anything spectacular here but then again no one did very p remember back a few years, the majority of the players were not at the minimum requirements.

What all this means, in the long run, is that these football players in stronger and faster than ever before in the history of the school. Th have already demonstrated a strong desire to do well in football summer of conditioning in order to get ready.

It's no wonder I came away excited about football... the coaching well prepared for the opening practice and was excited and the athlete good shape and showed that they were ready for things to start hap

---

It's really amazing to me the way the Sovereign men's fast p continues to be among 'the powers' within the state. This past we team downed three fine ball teams in Moulton Painting of Des Moine and Collins Radio of Cedar Rapids to assure themselves of a tie for th the state tournament after having finished fourth and sixth in th years.

I'm not certain that people really appreciate what a task this is fo team. While people from the area know that Jim Sovereign is among pitchers and that he contributes a great deal to the team, I'm not c rest of the team is given proper credit. While a good pitcher importance, I might point out that the team also played a good tournament to this point and have been coming up with enough runs

One of the things that is amazing about the Sovereign team is that don't play that many games as a team. It is made up of a group of pla various teams within the league here. As a rule, the team gets toge couple of warm up games before district tournament, plays th tournament, then plays in the Nordic Fest tournament, goes to the meet and then to the state meet. In between some of these tournam team will also see if they can't pick up a game here and there in an stay sharp. This is in complete contrast to a team such as Butt'r Topp the team together all season long and playing in tournaments just at weekend.

NG PRACTICE MONDAY—Cr
Bob McNew, goes through the f
backs in order to execute a p
e session for the Cadets Monda

Foot

just one practice under our bel
ll I can really report is that
to practice in pretty good sha
t we have 37 players who repor
arsity team," stated head footb
ob McNew Monday. "The pract
ll for us," he added.
ay was the first day of footb
e for 435 schools within the st
a High School Athletic associat
wing any contact with footb

Consignn

When

Where:

Protivin Wins Third in State Softball Tournament

It took two perennial state tournament teams to defeat Protivin in the state softball tournament.

Cedar Rapids Fleck's, the 1962 state and western regional champion, and Sioux City Gibson, the 1963 and 1964 state champions, were the only teams to give Protivin any trouble in the state meet. Protivin finished in third place behind these two teams.

Protivin, representing the smallest town competing in the state softball tournament, also had the youngest team in the tournament. Because of this and the good softball displayed by the Protivin club throughout the tournament, they won much praise and acclaim from the various sports writers and fans present.

As the tournament progressed, it appeared that Protivin became the sentimental favorite among the people present because it had emerged to the semi-finals undefeated competing against more veteran and more well known teams.

The main strength of the Protivin team throughout the tournament were its sharp pitching and tight defense. Protivin's pitchers, Jim Sovereign and Bud Svoboda, allowed opposing teams only 12 runs and 21 hits. This was the second lowest total of the entire tournament. Only Cedar Rapids Fleck's, state champion, allowed fewer runs (7) and hits (15). Protivin itself matched the opposition on hits with 21 while scoring nine runs in the tournament. Protivin committed only four errors, which was the lowest number of any team in the tournament.

In first round action, Protivin won over Des Moines Reams by a score of 2-1. This game was played before 2,200 fans, the largest number ever for an opening night's action. Jim Sovereign, pitching for Protivin, hurled a brilliant three hitter. He struck out 12 Des Moines batters.

In second round action Protivin defeated Charles City Salsbury 7-5. This game, which was on Saturday afternoon, was played under extremely difficult conditions as the temperature during the game stood at 95 degrees.

On Saturday evening, in semi-final action, Protivin and Cedar Rapids Fleck's met, each with 2-0 records. Both teams had emerged from their respective brackets unbeaten, with the winner going to the state finals. Cedar Rapids, behind the pitching of Jerry Ralfs, proved too much for the Protivin club and they won the game 4-0. Ralfs, regarded as the best pitcher in the state, allowed four hits and struck out 12 batters. Jim Sovereign, the smooth throwing Protivin right hander, allowed the hard hitting Cedar Rapids team only six hits.

Because of the double elimination rule, Protivin still had a second chance. On Sunday afternoon they met the defending state champion, Gibson of Sioux City. This game again was played with the temperature in the high 90's. Sioux City emerged victorious by a 2-0 score. Leroy Carlson, the veteran Sioux City pitcher, was appearing in his fifteenth straight state tournament.

He allowed Protivin a total of four hits and struck out 11 batters. Bud Svoboda, pitching for Protivin, pitched a tremendous game, allowing only three hits. But to Protivin's misfortune all three hits occurred in the fifth inning. The Sioux City runs were driven in on a single by winning pitcher Carlson.

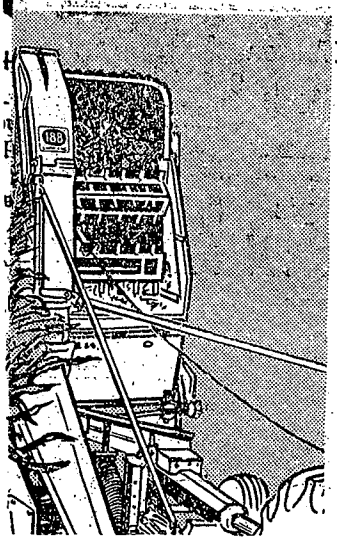
Sioux City, by its victory over Protivin, went on to face Cedar Rapids for the state championship. Cedar Rapids defeated Sioux City 2-0. Ralfs was the winning pitcher allowing only one hit to Sioux City. Carlson, the losing pitcher, allowed only five hits. Both Cedar Rapids runs scored with two out in the top of the seventh inning.

Much was done to increase softball interest in this area of the state with the recognition gained by the Protivin club in Des Moines. Many observers felt that better softball must be played in this area than in other areas of northeast Iowa, such as Dubuque, Mason City, and Waterloo. One comment constantly heard in Des Moines was that if the players which composed the Protivin club continued playing together, they would almost certainly be back for the 1966 state tournament.

Serves in Liberia

F. NORLYN STOWELL

F. Norlyn Stowell, who served as social science teacher in the Crestwood high school during the 1964-65 school year, has been named a Peace corps volunteer, having completed eight weeks of training at San Francisco college. He left for Liberia Sunday. Mr. Stowell is the son of Mr. and Mrs. Fred Stowell of Alpha, Minnesota.



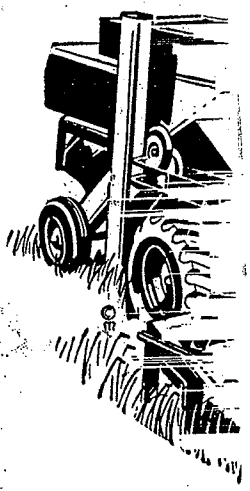
BACK - TO - SCHOOL
With Style and

day morning wi
and Margie and
son's brother-in-l
Mr. and Mrs. R
Margie of Denve
sisters-in-law, Mr.
bold of Lime Spr
George Johnson o
niece, Mrs. Laver
Sumner and Mrs.
of Lime Springs.

He is in a grou
who will teach at t
secondary school l
raise existing edu
ards. An acute te
in Liberia has resu
women with only e
ucations teaching th
The Peace corps
teach courses in
social studies and
the arrival of these
there will be more
corpsmen in Liberi

During his trainin
studied the history
customs of Liberia.
died educational the
cds and practiced
skills in San Fra
schools.

The departing vo
the 10,000 other Pea
working in 46 natio
Africa and Latin Am



Recent
in pellet
grain by

7/25/62

San Francisco at Houston (2).
Cincinnati 6, Pittsburgh 4.
MILWAUKEE 5, New York 4 (12 innings).

TODAY'S SCHEDULE

Philadelphia at Chicago.
New York at MILWAUKEE (night).
Los Angeles at St. Louis (night).
Pittsburgh at Cincinnati (night).
San Francisco at Houston (night).

THURSDAY'S SCHEDULE

New York at MILWAUKEE.
Pittsburgh at Cincinnati (night).
Only games scheduled.

Cleveland 8, Kansas City 4.
Baltimore 3-5, Los Angeles 2-8.

TODAY'S SCHEDULE

Boston at New York (2).
Chicago at Washington (night).
Detroit at MINNESOTA (night).
Cleveland at Kansas City (night).
Baltimore at Los Angeles (night).

THURSDAY'S SCHEDULE

Boston at New York.
Chicago at Washington (night).
Only games scheduled.

Zephyrs Coach

CHICAGO (AP)—Jack McMahon, who has worked both sides of pro basketball's fence, became new coach of the Chicago Zephyrs of the National Basketball Association today with this promise:

"I've never been with a loser and I don't intend to have one in Chicago." He has a two-season contract.

The 32-year-old McMahon comes to the one-season old Chicago NBA club after leading the Kansas City Steers to the best record, 58-28, last winter as the American Basketball League made its debut.

McMahon, although only 6-feet-1 played eight NBA seasons with the Rochester Royals and the St. Louis Hawks.

With the Zephyrs, who opened NBA play last season as the Chicago Packers, McMahon inherits a club with a 19-61 record, the worst won-lost mark in league history.

cagers to compete
of the regular sea
Russians in a pr
nine game series
To make such a
be an AAU adm
federation control
cagers.

Russell, the ne
tion head, concede
not plan any pe
recognition for at
the federation h
program of four
ent of the AAU.

Lee is C
Junior C

Bob Lee is the
handicap champi
Country Club.

He defeated
for the crown.

The 18-hole m
gress.

COULD MEAN CROWN

Lang's to Meet Mankato Tonight

Lang's Bar, paced by pitcher Jim Sovereign, will renew its National League softball rivalry with Mankato Bar and pitcher Jim Langowski at Franklin St. Field at 6:30 p.m. tonight.

Lang's owns a 15-2 record on the season while Mankato Bar stands 13-4.

Sovereign possesses a 15-2 mark on the campaign and has recorded 117 strike outs. He has allowed 27 walks and has an earned run average of .070.

In his possession are six shut outs. He has not given Mankato Bar an earned run in three games.

Sovereign's rival Langowski owns a mark that is almost as near-perfect.

He stands 13-3 on the year and has thrown five shut outs, three no-hitters and one perfect game.

In three outings against Lang's he has allowed just one run to score, that spelling a 1-0 defeat in the last game.

Lang's hitters are paced by Lance Carrol, who is batting at a .391 clip with 18 hits in 46 times at bat and nine RBIs.

Bob Hogenson is hitting .350 and the leading RBI producer is Bob Kosidowski, who is batting .349, with 18 runs batted in. He has hit four home runs.

Bruce Stanton is one of the leading Mankato hitters with a .358 mark on 22 hits in 65 times at bat. Gene Gorney is hitting .301 and Langowski is topping the heap with a .388 mark.

Bob Welch has four home runs and Stanton two. Gorney numbers six triples and five doubles among his hits.

Top Bowlers At St. Paul

ST. PAUL (AP) — Eighteen of the top 28 money winners are entered in the $20,000 Professional Bowling Association tournament here Thursday through Sunday.

Heading the entries are Billy Golembewski, Steve Nagy, Pat Patterson, Dale Seavoy, Bob Crawford, Vern Downing, Ron Gaudern, Robert Sims, Ed Lubanski and Bill Welu.

Vacationing Don Carter will not compete.

The first PBA tourney to be held in the Twin Cities opens with a pro-amateur event Thursday evening at the Maplewood Bowl. Two sessions a day are set for Friday, Saturday and Sunday.

Minor League Baseball

PACIFIC COAST LEAGUE

Seattle 4, San Diego 2.
Vancouver 6, Spokane 3.
Tacoma 11, Salt Lake City 6.
Hawaii 10, Portland 7.

FIRST PITCH HIT FOR HOMER

Miller Prove

By JIM BECKER
Associated Press Sports Writer

It took only one pitch for Robert G. Miller to prove he's a true New York Met.

Robert G. Miller is a left-handed pitcher. The Mets also have a Robert L. Miller, who is right-handed.

Robert L.'s record is 0-7. Robert G. had never thrown a ball for the Mets before Tuesday night. Then he threw one. Now he is 0-1.

Del Crandall hit the pitch for a home run in the bottom of the 12th to give the Milwaukee Braves a 5-4 victory over the Mets. It was the ninth straight loss for the Mets who are only one game over the .250 mark.

At the other end of the league, Willie Mays continued his hitting rampage with h
31 to lead the
ants to a 3-1
Houston Colts.
Giants to withi
league-leading

St. Louis Cardi

Joey Jay got
the Cincinnati
Pittsburgh 6-4
Cubs beat the
lies 5-3.

Houston right
rell, who admi
that he occasio
pitch into his
find any way
it was too late.
homers to the
leader in the
nings.

In the sixth

Cresco Merchants Softball Team Opens Here Thursday

The Cresco Merchants softball team will open its regular season with two doubleheaders here this week. Thursday night the Merchants will open against Rochester North Star Bar and Friday they will face La Crosse Pugy's Pizza.

All home games are doubleheaders which will be played at Evans Park beginning at 7:45 p.m.

Some of the team members, along with the Sovereign brothers, are Joel and Larry Leonard, Bill Sada, Chuck Olbendick, all from Cresco, Roger Cleveland from Lanta, Dave Vick from Ridgeway, Dick Drahota from Charles City, and Leon Griffin, Russell Rumla, and

Jim Sovereign, who along with his brother, Merle, have organized the team, noted, "We have 42 games scheduled so far, along with five tournaments. There is the possibility of a few more games and tournaments to be added yet."

Dennis Linderbaum from Decorah.

Here is the team schedule to date:

May 11 - Rochester - North Star Bar	Here
May 12 - La Crosse - Pugy's Pizza	Here
May 14 - Protivin	There
May 21 - Prairie du Chien - Bob's Bar	There
May 22 - St. Lucas	Here
May 27-28 - Waterloo Tournament	
June 1 - Clear Lake - Butt'r Tupp	There
June 3-4 - Prairie du Chien Tournament	
June 5 - Waterloo - Community Builders	There
June 7 - La Crosse - Randy Builders	There
June 8 - Rochester - Eagles	There
June 10-11 - Prairie du Chien Classic Tournament	Here
June 12 - Protivin	There
June 15 - Austin - Moose Lodge	There
June 20 - Waterloo - Community Builders	Here
June 22 - Waterloo - Pinky's Tap	Here
June 23,24,25 - Mason City Tournament	
June 27 - Rochester Eagles	Here
June 29 - La Crosse - Randy Builders	Here
July 1-2 - Winona Tournament	
July 11 - Clear Lake - Butt'r Tupp	Here
July 13 - Waterloo - Pinky's Tap	There
July 18 - La Crosse - Pugy's Pizza	There
July 20 - Austin - Moose Lodge	Here

Decorah Edges Eighth Graders For Relay Title

Late tallying of points earned at the Washington Junior High invitational track meet held on Saturday pushed Crestwood down to second place and gave previously-ranked second-place Decorah the first place title by six and one-half points.

In the field events, the Cadets got first place finishes from Rod Jones in the shot put and Bill Hagen in the high jump. Dave Ross picked up a fifth in the long jump for the other field event point.

John Murray led the Cadets in the individual running events with a win in the low hurdles. Other places were taken by Dave Strunk, third in the 50 yard dash, Francis Burns, fourth in the quarter, and Dave Ross, fifth in the 100 yard dash.

The 880 relay team of Bill Hagen, Kevin Carolan, Rod Jones, and Zane Blessum, and the 880 medley quartet of Hagen, Jones, Blessum, and Mark Billmyer garnered first places for Crestwood.

The shuttle hurdle quartet of Rick Jensen, Scott Stifle, Mark Billmyer, and John Murray placed second, while the 440 relay of Dave Strunk, Randy Greenfield, Scott Stifle, and Kevin Carolan placed third.

Running on the mile relay team that placed third were Jeff Boden, Rod Hagen, Wes Buckridge and Rick Jensen.

Fri.-Sat., May 12-13
"SKIN GAME"

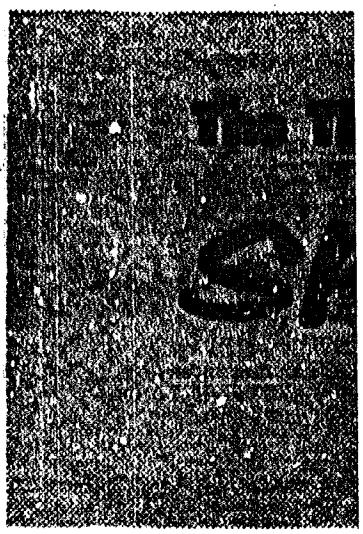
Men Get Tough Competition from Women Bowlers

Men and women bowling teams sponsored by four local firms had a bit of fun the other night as they competed in three games of bowling. It was tough competition, too, with two of the four women's teams defeating their competing men's team.

The Leuthold-Wendl women's team, with a handicap of 798, rolled a 2,962 to down the men's team from the same firm. The men had a 2,871, including a 441 handicap. On the women's team were Kris Qvara, Dianne Womark, Sue Sovereign, Judy Strike and Janet Entwistle. On the men's team were LaVerne Buttjer, Don Conway, Ward Curtis, Joe Serin and Bob Olson.

The Protivin Texaco girls, with a 723 handicap, had a 2,838 total compared to the men who, with a 387 handicap, racked up 2,780. The women included Mary Bader, Grace Komarek, Audrey Mlady, Blanche Sirek and Helen Fencl, while the men's team included Art Brunes, Bob Bader, Joe Fencl, Julius Riley and Don Sirek.

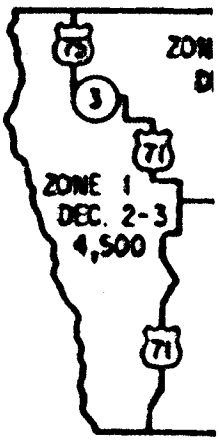
Red Owl women provided competition but lost to the men by a few pins, 2,917 to 2,865. The men, with a handicap of 408, included Dick Schotik, Max Sitka, John Oruba, Wayne Musick and Paul Bateman while the women, with a



Girls Trac

The Crestwood girls track team
most of the year by defeating Wand
win in a triangular at Washington la
Crestwood scored 77 1/2 team poi
66 1/2 and Oelwein 42.

Faye Perkins turned in one of t
formances in the state in winning
dash in 2.1 seconds. The time w
of a second off the state record. Fa
the long jump and then turned ba
anchoring the winning 440 and 880 j
Also running on the 440 relay were



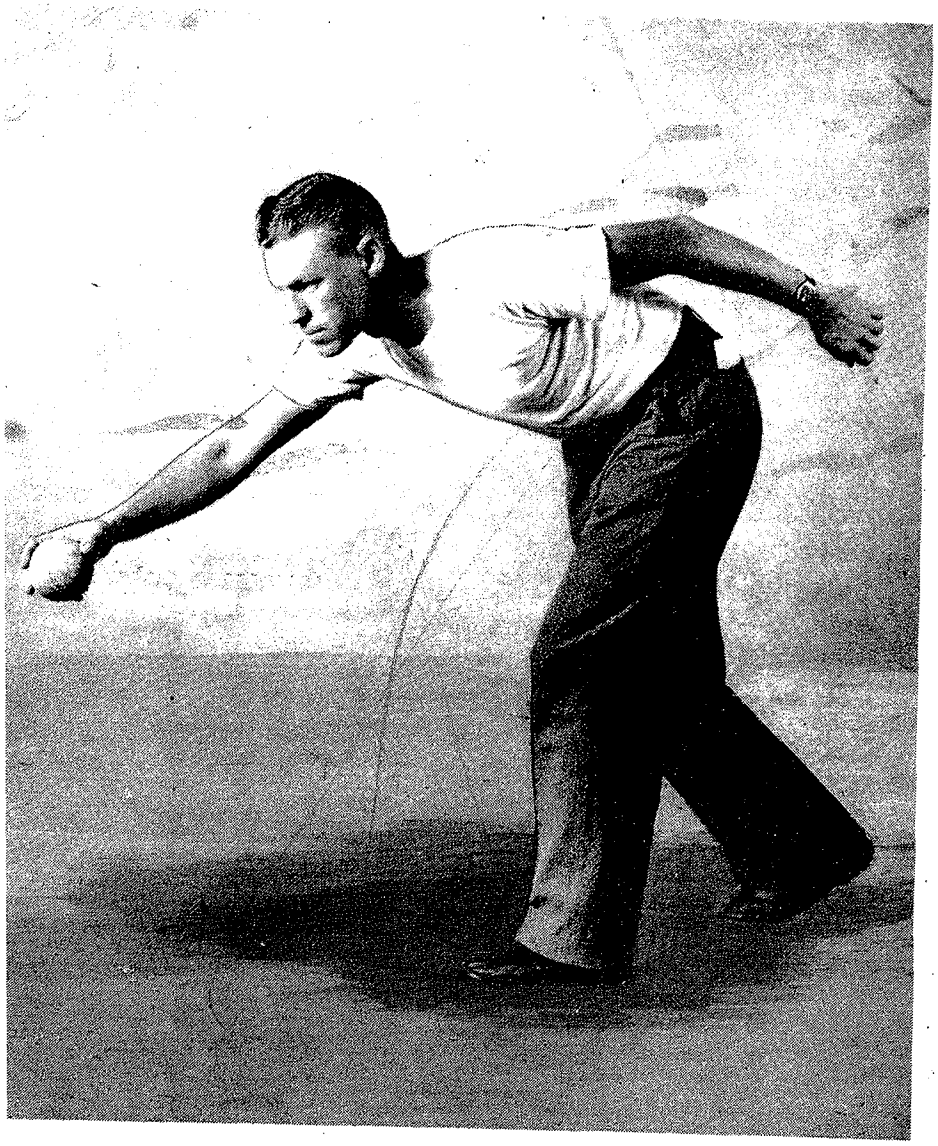
Deer Hunt

The State Conservation Comm
nounced today the 1978 Iowa deer hunt
and regulations, including only a two-
for extreme northeast Iowa.

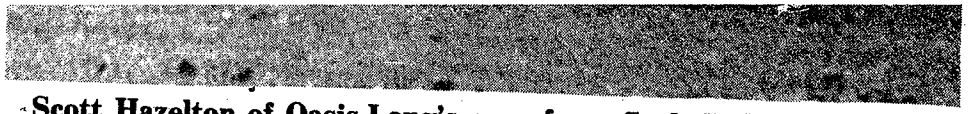
In order to increase the deer ha
central and east central Iowa, hunte

een some spectacular moundsmen over he years. Names like Earl Kreuzer, Rich Bell, Darby O'Brien, Mark Kolter, Stan Knopick, and Paul Rademacher befuddled atters from the late 30's to the middle 0's and Jim Sovereign, Jim Langowski, aul Fay, Dave Lundak, and John Ernster

"If you were dead." Knopick said, "I don't know why I learned that pitch but it looked like it rolled off a table. I used to practice day and night and my philosophy was to throw strikes. I got so that I could pitch blindfolded. I went two full games without a walk and had two consecutive no-hitters. For awhile they were calling



Darby O'Brien, a Winona soft-ball pitcher from a few years back. [photo courtesy of Winona County Historical Society]



Scott Hazelton of Oasis-Lang's goes for a fly ball. [photo courtesy Loren Benz]

me the Johnny Vandermeer of fast-pitch. At one time I had a string of 40 straight batters without a hit."

When fast pitch was the only show in town both players and fans flocked to the games. There were eight teams in Class "A" ball, from 12-16 in Class "B", and from six to eight in the "C" league. The effect was like that of the farm system in the Major Leagues; players moved up the ladder at their own speed as their ability and experience increased.

Before semipro baseball and other pursuits stole some of the luster from diamond ball, as many as 2300 fans jammed Gabrych Park to watch the King and His Court perform. Eddie Feigner and his three team-mates took on a complete team of Winona All Stars and produced entertainment which completely captivated the crowd. Feigner would flip the ball behind his back to pick off runners from first base, pitch blindfolded, and demonstrated his 104 m.p.h. fastball as he struck out an average of 17 batters a game.

"Feigner was a professional and most of the things that he did were just trick stuff." maintained Max Kulas, "I've never seen him in a situation where he really had to pitch and meet the other team head to head. When I faced him he was already a little past his prime, but I don't think that he was all that much of a problem to face and Winona didn't have that much trouble hitting off him. He was tough, don't let me kid you. Anybody who can strike out ten or twelve players in a game is good, but I imagine that Jim Sovereign could have played with four guys a lot of the time too."

Jim Sovereign was probably one of the last of the great fast-pitch hurlers. Sovereign came to Winona from Iowa and played fast-pitch while a student at Winona State. The wiry pitcher's blazing fastball, low-key confidence and duels with Jim Langowski produced some legendary moments in the annals of Winona fast-pitch memory.

"Sovereign's heyday was in the 50's. His fastball was clocked at over 100 m.p.h." said Kulas, "He was fast, and that was his problem. He was too fast. He used to play games where he'd lose 1-0. His team

Continued on page 11

Post

Publisher: John Edstrom

Editor-in-Chief: Frances Edstrom

Associate Editor: Patrick P. Marek

Production Mgr: Michael M. Schultz

Composition Chief: Marlene Bergdale

Composition: Linda Smit

Business Manager: Patrick P. Marek

Pressroom Superintendent: Mark Gunderson

Operations Director: Barbara Serreyn

Circulation Mgr: John Kerr

Office Co-ordinator: Cheryl Merrill

Advertising Information: 1-507-452-1262

Letters to the Editor:

P.O. Box 27, Winona, MN 55987